



Situation

<https://www.youtube.com/embed/oSaH3a9IGbk>

Fernando Braña Asensio. Adam (CC BY-NC-SA)

I am in **Ireland** at last. I am working for a company called "**Irish Market Trends**", a **consultancy firm** where I will have to put everything I learnt into practice and many other aspects that are inherent to this kind of job. I will have to write **business reports** commissioned by different companies, **answer the phone to talk to clients** or **write customer reviews**. Throughout this last unit, I will show you what my daily life at the office looks like. I hope you find it useful!



Aims

This aim of this unit is to **write professional documents, reviews and reports**, belonging to the sector or to the daily life at work. Also, the unit aims to provide situations so that the students **understand information of a professional, academic and daily nature** contained in **phone conversations**, accurately interpreting the content of the message. Finally, another objective of this unit is to produce and understand these kinds of oral or written texts taking into account the most significant features of the customs and usages of the community where the foreign language is spoken.



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Use of English. Passive voice



Situation

<https://www.youtube.com/embed/OomYMBRcSUg>

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In this section, we are going to deal with the **Passive Voice**. It is mainly used to change the focus of the sentence when we prefer to focus on the action rather than on who did it. The Passive is also used mainly in **formal, scientific or business, and commercial** writing. Now that I am working in Ireland, I think it's a good moment to go over it and check its uses and main features, which will help me **write emails or reports** when I am at the office.

The Passive Voice



Piqsels. grammar (CC BY-NC-SA)

The **Passive Voice** is one of the two voices we have in English. It is mainly used when we need to **emphasize what is being done** rather than who does it. The Passive voice is found in **commercial, technical or scientific writing** so knowing how to use it correctly is key to enhance the clarity, formality, and focus of our writing, which is essential for effective communication in business and academic settings.

DIFFERENCES ACTIVE-PASSIVE VOICE

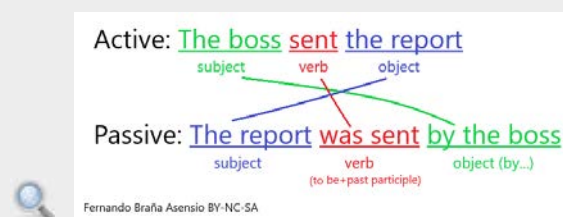
If we want to transform a sentence in the active voice into a sentence in the passive voice there are three changes that we must consider:

- ✓ The Active object (direct or indirect) becomes the Subject of the Passive voice
- ✓ The Passive verb is formed with the verb "to be" in the same tense as the active verb plus

the active verb in the past participle form

- ✓ The Active subject becomes the Pasive agent introduced by the preposition "by". However, it is important to know when to use the agent and when not. We will deal with this later.

Example:



Fernando Braña Asensio. *passive voice* ([CC BY-NC-SA](#))

CHANGES IN VERB TENSES

VERB TENSE	ACTIVE	PASSIVE
Present Simple	<i>The boss sends the report</i>	<i>The report is sent by the boss</i>
Present Progressive	<i>The boss is sending the report</i>	<i>The report is being sent by the boss</i>
Past Simple	<i>The boss sent the report</i>	<i>The report was sent by the boss</i>
Past Progressive	<i>The boss was sending the report</i>	<i>The report was being sent by the boss</i>
Present Perfect	<i>The boss has sent the report</i>	<i>The report has been sent by the boss</i>
Present Perfect Progressive	<i>The boss has been sending the report</i>	<i>The report has been being sent by the boss</i>
Past Perfect	<i>The boss had sent the report</i>	<i>The report had been sent by the boss</i>
Past Perfect Progressive	<i>The boss had been sending the report</i>	<i>The report had been being sent by the boss</i>
Future Simple	<i>The boss will send the report</i>	<i>The report will be sent by the boss</i>
Future Progressive	<i>The boss will be sending the report</i>	<i>The report will be being sent by the boss</i>
Future Perfect	<i>The boss will have sent the report</i>	<i>The report will have been sent by the boss</i>

Be going to	The boss is going to send the report	Th report is going to be sent by the boss
Modal Verbs	The boss should/must/can/may(...) send the report	The report should/must/can/may (...) be sent by the boss

ACTIVE TO PASSIVE (DOUBLE OBJECT)

Sometimes, the Passive Voice can be done in two ways. The subject of the Passive Voice can be the Direct or the Indirect object of the Passive Voice.



Fernando Braña Asensio. *Passive two objects* ([CC BY-NC-SA](#))

WHEN TO USE (or not) THE AGENT

The Agent is used when:

- ✓ It gives important information to the sentence:
 - ✦ *Our house was designed by a famous architect*
 - ✦ *The email was sent by the president of the company*

The Agent is not used when:

- ✓ When it is obvious who did the action
 - ✦ *The murderer was arrested last night (it is not necessary to say "by the police", because it is obvious)*
- ✓ When we don't know who did the action or is irrelevant
 - ✦ *The night shift was changed (I don't know who did it)*
- ✓ When the subject is no-one important or specific (someone, poeple,they you...)
 - ✦ *The room was painted last night (we don't say "by someone")*

IMPERSONAL PASSIVE

The verbs **think**, **believe**, **say**, **report**, **expect**, **consider**, **understand**, **claim** or **state** are frequently used in impersonal passives:

✓ Active:

✚ *People believe that the manager sent the email last week*

✓ Impersonal passive (2 ways):

✚ *It is believed that the manager sent the email last week*

✚ *The manager is believed to have sent the email last week*

The second structure is a bit more difficult so we will try to stick to the first one.

PRESENTATION

https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/e/2PACX-1vSG7E04LgrcnYmzgLPzR_kmVDd-fsFlwQjY53tNSwR9NkhR7Sk3rYjbyRt7GTUvMqwGD4fePdokCmhP/embed?start=false&loop=false&delayms=3000

Fernando Braña Asensio. *Passive Voice* (CC BY-NC-SA)



Passive verb tenses

Choose the correct verb tense in the passive voice

A.-

Active: The company will hire new employees next month.

Passive: New employees by the company next month.

B.-

Active: The manager is conducting performance reviews this week.

Passive: Performance reviews by the manager this week.

C.-

Active: The workers completed the project ahead of schedule.

Passive: The project ahead of schedule by the workers.

D.-

Active: The HR department organized a training session for all staff.

Passive: A training session for all staff by the HR department.

E.-

Active: The union negotiated better working conditions for its members.

Passive: Better working conditions for its members by the union.

F.-

Active: The supervisor has assigned new tasks to the team.

Passive: New tasks to the team by the supervisor.

G.-

Active: The company is implementing a new health and safety policy.

Passive: A new health and safety policy by the company.

H.-

Active: The employees are discussing the proposed changes.

Passive: The proposed changes by the employees.

I.-

Active: The director will announce the new project tomorrow.

Passive: The new project by the director tomorrow.

J.-

Active: The labor board must evaluate the working conditions.

Passive: The working conditions by the labor board.

Check



Active to Passive

Fill in the gaps to turn the active voice sentences into passive ones

A.-

Active: "The manager approved the budget proposal yesterday."

Passive: " [] [] [] the manager yesterday."

B.-

Active: "Our team completed the project ahead of schedule."

Passive: " [] [] ahead of schedule by our team."

C.-

Active: "The CEO will announce the new marketing strategy tomorrow."

Passive: " [] [] announced [] the CEO tomorrow."

D.-

Active: "The board members discussed the merger extensively."

Passive: " [] [] extensively [] the board members."

E.-

Active: "They awarded the contract to the most qualified bidder."

Passive: " [] [] to the most qualified bidder."

F.-

Active: "The company launched its new product line last month."

Passive: " [] [] [] the company last month."

G.-

Active: "The sales team exceeded their quarterly targets."

Passive: " [] [] [] the sales team."

H.-

Active: "We are upgrading our IT infrastructure next week."

Passive: "Our IT infrastructure [] next week."

I.-

Active: "They assigned the task to the most experienced employee."

Passive: " [] [] to the most experienced employee."

J.-

Active: "The accountant prepared the financial reports for the annual meeting."

Passive: " [] for the annual meeting [] ."

Submit



Fill in the blanks

Listen to the following sentences and fill in with the correct passive verb



Fernando Braña Asensio (clipchamp). *Passive voice* (CC BY-NC-SA)

1. The sales figures [] [] to identify the underlying causes of the decline last term.
2. Customer feedback [] [] through surveys and online reviews.
3. Marketing strategies [] [] for their effectiveness in reaching the target audience.
4. Product quality issues [] [] by numerous customers.
5. The financial impact [] [] by calculating the revenue loss.
6. Training programs for the sales team [] [] to improve performance.
7. Competitor strategies [] [] to identify potential gaps next month.
8. A new loyalty program [] [] to retain existing customers.
9. Operational efficiencies [] [] by optimizing the supply chain.
10. A comprehensive report [] [] to outline strategic recommendations.

Submit



IMPERSONAL PASSIVES

Turn the following active sentences into impersonal passives beginning with "It..."

1

ACTIVE: They **believe** that the new marketing strategy will increase sales.

PASSIVE: It [] [] that the new marketing strategy will increase sales.

2

ACTIVE: People [] that customer satisfaction rates have dropped.

PASSIVE: It [] [] that customer satisfaction rates have dropped.

3

ACTIVE: The team **expects** that the project will be completed by the end of the month.

PASSIVE: It [] [] that the project will be completed by the end of the month.

4

ACTIVE: Several employees **noted** concerns about the new policy.

PASSIVE: It [] [] that several employees had expressed concerns about the new policy.

5

ACTIVE: Management **considers** it essential to improve the company's digital presence.

PASSIVE: It [] [] essential to improve the company's digital presence.

6

ACTIVE: The committee **has suggested** conducting additional training sessions.

PASSIVE: It [] [] that additional training sessions should be conducted.

7

ACTIVE: The finance department **assumes** the budget will be approved.

PASSIVE: It [] [] that the budget will be approved by the finance department.

8

ACTIVE: They **reported** that the supply chain disruption had caused delays.

PASSIVE: It [] [] that the supply chain disruption had caused delays.

9

ACTIVE: Industry leaders **recognize** that innovation is crucial for staying competitive.

PASSIVE: It [] [] that innovation is crucial for staying competitive.

10

ACTIVE: The organizers **have confirmed** that the annual meeting will take place next week.

PASSIVE: It [] [] that the annual meeting will take place next week.

Submit



Do we need the agent?

Read then following sentences and decide wheteher we need the agent or not

1.-The annual budget was approved

- ☐ by the board of directors
- ☐ we don't need to mention the agent

Correct: Use of agent "by the board of directors" clarifies who approved the budget.

Wrong

Solution

1. Correct Option
2. Wrong

2.- A new marketing strategy was implemented last term

- ☐ by them
- ☐ No agent needed, focus is on the strategy being implemented.

Wrong

Correct Option

Solution

1. Wrong
2. Correct Option

3.- The report was prepared

- ☐ by the finance department
- ☐ No agent needed

Correct: Use of agent "by the finance department" specifies who prepared the report.

Wrong

Solution

1. Correct Option
2. Wrong

4.- Employee performance reviews are conducted annually

- ☐ No agent needed, the focus is on the action being regularly conducted.
- ☐ by some people in the department

Correct Option

Wrong

Solution

1. Correct Option
2. Wrong

5.- The project deadline was extended

- ☐ by the project manager.
- ☐ No agent needed

Correct: Use of agent "by the project manager" clarifies who extended the deadline

Wrong

Solution

1. Correct Option
2. Wrong

6.- Customer feedback was collected through surveys

- ☐ No agent needed, focus is on the action of collecting feedback
- ☐ by one of my colleagues

Correct Option

Wrong

Solution

1. Correct Option
2. Wrong

7.- The new software was developed

- ☐ by our IT team.
- ☐ No agent needed

Correct: Use of agent "by our IT team" specifies who developed the software.

Wrong

Solution

1. Correct Option
2. Wrong

8.- Training sessions will be held next month

- ☐ No agent needed, the focus is on the timing of the training sessions.
- ☐ by them.

Correct Option

Wrong

Solution

1. Correct Option
2. Wrong

9.- The proposal was rejected due to budget constraints

- ☐ No agent needed, focus is on the reason for rejection.
- ☐ by someone.

Correct Option

Wrong

Solution

1. Correct Option
2. Wrong

10.- The product launch was announced

- ☐ by the CEO
- ☐ No agent needed

Correct: Use of agent "by the CEO" clarifies who made the announcement.

Wrong

Solution

1. Correct Option
2. Wrong



A Step Ahead

Give these links a go if you want to practise a bit more!

- ✓ [English grammar](#)
- ✓ [My English pages](#)
- ✓ [BBC Learning English](#)
- ✓ [Test English](#)
- ✓ [Business English](#)

Vocabulary: Writing a Report



Situation

<https://www.youtube.com/embed/BmuzHwPgkPY>

Fernando Braña Asensio. *Adam* (CC BY-NC-SA)

Writing a report is one of the most **difficult** aspects of professional English. When facing the writing of one we must stick to some **features and conventions**: A report must use **formal and objective language** and the information must be presented in a **clear, logical, concise, direct** way. The main aim is to convey relevant information, findings, or advice and transmit it to a particular audience in a **well-structured** way. The information presented must provide **evidence** to bolster and support statistics, data, or opinions. I have received an assignment at the office to write a report, and the following explanation will surely help me. Do you want to join me?

Some useful tips & Vocabulary on writing a report

Paragraph Headings

A good, professional report may take several pages. However, depending on the level or the report, it may take less space. A good way to structure it is to keep paragraphs, which will also make it easier for the reader to follow. Dividing a report in four paragraphs is an effective manner to organise our information:

- ✓ **Introduction:** Sets the context and shapes the aim of the report
- ✓ **Paragraph 2 :** Contains the findings and analysis related to the topic we are writing about
- ✓ **Paragraph 3:** In this paragraph a deeper analysis and further information or recommendations must be included
- ✓ **Conclusion:** It must summarize the key points mentioned in the report and also a call for action

The name of the paragraph headings should be descriptive and focused on the content

Introductions

- ✓ The goal of this report is to explain / share / talk about / wrap up ...

- ✔ After visiting ..., I have created this report.
- ✔ I recently visited ... and prepared this report for you.
- ✔ This included visiting / examining ... / I collected the data by ...
- ✔ To create this report, I conducted / talked about / distributed a survey ...
- ✔ It is based on what I observed / the feedback I received ...
- ✔ I present my findings below. / My findings are outlined below.
- ✔ The report includes the necessary information about the issue as requested.

Introduce Points

- ✔ Let's begin with ... / First off ...
- ✔ First ... / To start with ... / The initial aspect to consider is ...
- ✔ Second ... / Third ... / Additionally ...
- ✔ Furthermore ... / Moreover ... / Another thing to consider is ...
- ✔ Apart from that ... / In addition ... / Moreover ...

Introduce your Opinion

- ✔ I think / believe that ... / In my opinion ... / I am of the opinion that ... / It seems to me that ...
- ✔ Personally I believe that ... / In my view ... / As far as I am concerned ...
- ✔ I would like to suggest / recommend ... / ...
- ✔ I (strongly) recommend ... / My recommendation is to ...

Introduce other opinions

- ✔ Many people stated / reported / complained ...
- ✔ According to ... / As ... mentioned ... / In the words of ...
- ✔ It is said/believed/stated/claimed/suggested that ...

Write about Findings

- ✓ To identify, analyze, and compare ..., interviews were conducted within a 3-week period.
- ✓ The research took place/was carried out over a 2-month period.
- ✓ Having analyzed the data, it is evident that ...
- ✓ Statistical data suggests that ...
- ✓ Based on the survey results, it was discovered that ...
- ✓ The key discovery was .../The most relevant finding was...

Recommendations

- ✓ It is prudent to introduce/execute/arrange/implement/organise ...
- ✓ It is crucial/essential/of the utmost importance that we enhance/enhance/discover/find/improve ...
- ✓ It is advisable to ...
- ✓ It is (highly/strongly) recommended that ...
- ✓ We should consider/take into account ...
- ✓ The company should hire/review/change ...

Conclusions

- ✓ Based on the information above, it is clear that ...
- ✓ Considering everything, I believe that ...
- ✓ Overall, I found that ...
- ✓ In conclusion ... / To sum up ... / In summary ...
- ✓ In a nutshell ... / To summarize ...
- ✓ The above findings show/indicate that...
- ✓ It is therefore advisable that some action should/needs to be taken to ...
- ✓ As a result of the research ..., several issues/aspects need to be solved.
- ✓ In the light of recent results, there are still some aspects which require further action

Presentation

https://www.canva.com/design/DAGJJ_rfg_c/UPIUNTyUs5g6daDE31tJqg/view?embed

Sample Report

<https://www.youtube.com/embed/NjRHDgbmGK4>

Fernando Braña Asensio. *Adam*

Business Report: Analysis of Declining Sales at the "Irish Clothing Company™" and Recommendations for Improvement

Introduction

The goal of this report is to explain the significant decline in sales at the "Irish Clothing Company™" over the last term. After visiting the company, I have identified the key factors that have contributed to a 25% decrease in revenue compared to the same period last year. The aim is to provide an overview of the challenges that were faced by the company and suggest strategic actions to change this trend. The analysis includes market conditions, consumer behaviour, operational challenges, and customer feedback, supported by relevant statistical data.

Findings

To identify and analyze these factors several surveys were carried over the last year (see Appendix). Based on results, the most relevant finding was that consumers have stopped spending on non-essential items due to a broader financial crisis. Additionally, a significant shift toward online shopping due to lower prices, accelerated by the COVID-19 pandemic, has highlighted that the "Irish Clothing Company™" has an underdeveloped online presence. The company's product line has not kept pace with changing fashion trends, which has turned into a supply-demand mismatch. Concerns about product quality and inadequate customer service have also been pointed out, leading to decreased satisfaction.

Recommendations

It is highly recommendable to take several strategic actions. The company's online presence should enhance its presence online, which includes upgrading the e-commerce platform and investing more resources in digital marketing. It is strongly advisable to implement stricter quality control measures. A better supply chain management and comprehensive customer service training must be implemented to improve operational service, which will help to reduce disruptions and improve customer satisfaction. Additionally, customers can be retained by introducing loyalty programs and personalized promotions over seasonal marketing campaigns.

Conclusion

Based on the information above, the decline in sales at the "Irish Clothing Company™" must be attributed to a combination of economic factors, changing consumer behaviour, operational challenges, and inadequate marketing strategies. In the light of these results, further promotional strategies must be implemented to grow in sales. Immediate action on the provided recommendations is essential to reverse the downward trend and secure the company's market position in the competitive landscape. It is therefore advisable to take further action so that their online presence is enhanced and improved to align the product line with current trends. To summarize, this report outlines a strategic path, emphasizing the need for adaptation and positive measures to regain market share and improve overall performance.

1

Fernando Braña Asensio. report (CC BY-NC-SA)



Fill in with the correct word

Read the sentences below and fill in the missing words (with the words given below):

cost|demand|firstly|imported|implementing|labor| made|marketing|reasons|report |
should|supply|solve

1. ...so apples are []
2. To [] these problems,...
3. ...because of larger-scale production and lower [] []
4. Several [] for the import of apples.
5. [] these recommendations
6. Training and resources [] be given
7. [] investment in better farming techniques and technology should be [] ...
8. [] campaigns highlighting...
9. This [] will analyze...
10.between the [] and [] of Asturian apples,

Submit



Read a Report

Read the report below and fill in with phrases from the previous exercise

Report: Enhancing the Production and Use of Asturian Apples for Cider

Introduction

The "Asturian Apple Company" is known for producing high-quality apples used in cider. Recently, apples from other regions have been imported to make cider. [] why this is happening and suggest ways to improve the production and use of different Asturian apple varieties. Understanding these reasons can help strengthen the market for Asturian apples.

Findings

[] from other regions have been identified. Firstly, there is a big gap [], especially during the peak cider production times. Local production cannot meet the high demand, []. Secondly, cost factors are important. Apples from other regions are often cheaper []. Lastly, the quality and consistency of local apple varieties can vary due to changing weather and farming practices, making them less reliable for large-scale cider production.

Recommendations

[], several steps are suggested. [] to increase the yield and quality of Asturian apples. Secondly, agreements with local farmers

should be developed to ensure a more stable and consistent supply of apples. [redacted] to these farmers to improve their practices. [redacted] the unique qualities and heritage of Asturian apples should also be created to attract more consumers. Finally, financial help from regional authorities could be sought to reduce production costs and make local apples more competitive.

[redacted]

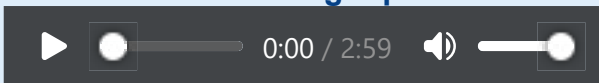
The importation of apples for cider production is a challenge for The Asturian Apple Company. By addressing supply gaps, cost issues, and quality concerns with strategic investments and partnerships, the production and use of Asturian apple varieties can be improved. Strengthening the local supply chain and promoting the special qualities of Asturian apples will support the local economy and ensure the continued success of Asturian cider. [redacted] will help The Asturian Apple Company better compete in the market and maintain the tradition of high-quality cider production.

Submit



A report about the "Natural Paradise"

Listen to the following report and fill in with the correct words



Fernando Braña Asensio (clipchamp). *report massive tourism* ([CC BY-NC-SA](#))

Report: Managing Tourism to Preserve Asturias' Natural and Cultural Heritage

Introduction

Natural Paradise is a leading tourism company dedicated to promoting the unique beauty and cultural heritage of Asturias. Recently, there has been a significant influx of tourists from other parts of Spain to this region. [redacted] the reasons behind this trend and propose measures to manage tourism in a way that preserves Asturias' nature, traditions, and cultural resources. By understanding the [redacted] driving this surge in tourism, we can [redacted] strategies to sustain the region's natural and cultural integrity.

Findings

Several [redacted] have contributed to the increase in tourists visiting Asturias. [redacted], the region's stunning landscapes, pristine beaches, and lush forests have gained widespread attention, particularly as people seek outdoor experiences following the pandemic. [redacted], Asturias' rich cultural heritage, including traditional festivals, historic sites, and local cuisine, attracts visitors looking for authentic experiences. [redacted], effective marketing campaigns and improved accessibility, such as better transportation links, have made Asturias a more popular destination. [redacted], the rise in tourism has led to concerns about environmental degradation, overcrowding, and the erosion of local traditions and cultures.

Recommendations

To address these challenges, several [] are []. Firstly, [] stricter regulations and quotas on the number of visitors allowed in sensitive natural areas can help prevent environmental damage. Secondly, [] off-season tourism can distribute tourist numbers more evenly throughout the year, reducing peak-time pressure on resources. Thirdly, [] responsible tourism through educational campaigns can raise awareness among visitors about the importance of preserving nature and respecting local cultures. Lastly, [] with local communities to develop sustainable tourism practices can ensure that tourism benefits residents without compromising their way of life.

Conclusion

The surge in tourism to Asturias presents both [] and []. While it brings economic [], it also [] the region's natural and cultural heritage. By adopting a [] approach that includes regulation, education, and community involvement, "Natural Paradise" can help manage tourism sustainably. This will ensure that Asturias remains a pristine and culturally rich destination for future generations. Implementing these [] will enable "Natural Paradise" to lead the way in promoting [] tourism practices that protect and preserve Asturias' unique character.

Submit



A Step Ahead

If you need to learn more vocabulary about business reports you will find further information here:

✔ [Business report. Phrases](#) 

✔ [Vocabulary used when writing reports](#) 



Situation

<https://www.youtube.com/embed/hp-2kfLcC-8>

Fernando Braña Asensio. Adam (CC BY-NC-SA)

One of my duties at my new company, **"Irish Market Trends"** is to **write reports** for other companies. Below, you will find a couple of them commissioned by two different companies, **"Velvet Cocoa"**, a chocolate company and **"Green Tech solutions"**, whose main field is technology. "Velvet Cocoa" wants to find out why their **sales have been going down** whereas "Green Tech solutions" needs to discover why some **operational efficiency and market expansion strategies are wrong**. I hope you can understand them and help you in your future jobs.

Velvet Cocoa report



Situation

<https://www.youtube.com/embed/rIOQ-A4yQXk>

Fernando Braña Asensio. Adam (CC BY-NC-SA)

Below you will find the report commissioned by "**Velvet Cocoa**". They are going through a hard time since their sales have not met their expectations over the last two terms and need to redirect their company strategies so they can recover their economy. I have written a report in four paragraphs following the structure in the vocabulary section of this unit. I would like you to give it a second reading and check if you can understand it. By doing so, I hope it will eventually help you.



Play with words & definitions

Match the following words that appear in the report with the corresponding definitions



[PRESS TO PLAY](#)



Velvet Cocoa report

Read the report below and then answer the questions

"Analysis and Strategic Recommendations for Revitalizing Velvet Cocoa's Chocolate Sales"
by Adam Brannagh

JUNE 26, 2024

Introduction

A report has been commissioned to "Irish Market Trends" by "Velvet Cocoa" to analyze the reasons behind the decline in sales of their chocolate products over the last two terms. This report aims to identify the key factors contributing to the reduced sales performance. Comprehensive market analysis, customer feedback, and competitive benchmarking have been utilized to gather relevant data and insights.

Findings

It has been found that several factors have contributed to the decline in sales of Velvet Cocoa's products. First, increased competition from both local and international brands has been observed, offering similar products at more competitive prices. Second, feedback from customer surveys has indicated that changes in the product packaging and formulation have not been well received. Additionally, a significant shift in consumer preferences towards healthier and more organic options has been noted, with Velvet Cocoa's current product range being perceived as less aligned with these trends.

Recommendations

To address the identified issues, several recommendations have been proposed. It is suggested that Velvet Cocoa consider revising its pricing strategy to remain competitive in the market. Additionally, the reintroduction of the previous packaging design and formulation, which were more popular among consumers, should be evaluated. Expanding the product line to include healthier and organic chocolate options is also recommended to cater to changing consumer preferences. Furthermore, a targeted marketing campaign focusing on the premium quality and unique aspects of Velvet Cocoa's products should be launched to reinforce brand loyalty and attract new customers.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the decline in sales experienced by Velvet Cocoa over the last two terms has been attributed to increased competition, unfavourable changes in product packaging and formulation, and a shift in consumer preferences towards healthier options. By implementing the recommended strategies, it is believed that Velvet Cocoa can regain its market position and enhance its sales performance. Continuous monitoring of market trends and consumer feedback will be crucial in ensuring the long-term success of the brand.

A report by Irish Market Trends-
Dun Laoghaire- Dublin-D18 Phone no. 987654321 irishmktrends@cidead.ie
COMMISSIONED BY "VELVET COCOA"

Fernando Braña Asensio. *velvet cocoa report* ([CC BY-NC-SA](#))

1.- The report was commissioned to analyze the reasons behind the increase in sales of Velvet Cocoa's chocolate products over the last two terms.

☐ True ☐ False

False

The report was commissioned to analyze the reasons behind the decline in sales of Velvet Cocoa's chocolate products over the last two terms.

2.- Increased competition from both local and international brands has been identified as a factor in the decline of Velvet Cocoa's sales.

☐ True ☐ False

True

Increased competition from both local and international brands has been identified as a factor in the decline of Velvet Cocoa's sales.

3.- Customer feedback indicated that the new packaging and formulation of Velvet Cocoa's products were well received.

☐ True ☐ False

False

Customer feedback indicated that the new packaging and formulation of Velvet Cocoa's products were not well received.

4.- A significant shift in consumer preferences towards healthier and more organic options has been noted as a contributing factor to the decline in sales.

☐ True ☐ False

True

A significant shift in consumer preferences towards healthier and more organic options has been noted as a contributing factor to the decline in sales.

5.- It is recommended that Velvet Cocoa maintain its current pricing strategy to remain competitive in the market.

☐ True ☐ False

False

It is recommended that Velvet Cocoa revise its current pricing strategy to remain competitive in the market.

6.- Expanding the product line to include healthier and organic chocolate options is one of the recommendations made in the report.

☐ True ☐ False

True

Expanding the product line to include healthier and organic chocolate options is one of the recommendations made in the report.

7.- The report suggests discontinuing the premium quality aspects of Velvet Cocoa's products.

☐ True ☐ False

False

The report suggests emphasizing, not discontinuing, the premium quality aspects of Velvet Cocoa's products.

8.- A targeted marketing campaign focusing on the unique aspects of Velvet Cocoa's products is recommended to attract new customers.

☐ True ☐ False

True

A targeted marketing campaign focusing on the unique aspects of Velvet Cocoa's

products is recommended to attract new customers.

9.- Continuous monitoring of market trends and consumer feedback is deemed unnecessary for the long-term success of the brand.

☐ True ☐ False

False

Continuous monitoring of market trends and consumer feedback is deemed crucial for the long-term success of the brand.

10.- The report concludes that the decline in sales can be addressed by revising the pricing strategy, reintroducing previous packaging designs, and expanding the product line to include healthier options.

☐ True ☐ False

True

The report concludes that the decline in sales can be addressed by revising the pricing strategy, reintroducing previous packaging designs, and expanding the product line to include healthier options.

Green Tech Solutions report



Situation

<https://www.youtube.com/embed/yoWfNCc9f90>

Fernando Braña Asensio. Adam (CC BY-NC-SA)

The report below is the one commissioned by "**Green Tech Solutions**". Their operational efficiency and market expansion strategies seem to have gone wrong for some time now. The report I wrote also follows the four-paragraph structure and includes passive verbs to focus on the actions. I have used some technical terms so before you read it, I would like you to check the meaning of some words and expressions. I hope you will find them useful and you can use them when it comes to writing a report of your own.



Match the correct word

The following words appear in the report. Match them with the correct definitions



[PRESS TO PLAY](#)



Green Tech Report

Read the report and answer these questions

Operational Efficiency and Market Expansion Strategies for GreenTech Solutions

by Adam Brannagh

Introduction

A report has been commissioned to analyze the operational efficiency and market expansion strategies for "GreenTech Solutions". The main goal of this report is to find out why some processes are not working well and to discover new opportunities to expand the market. This analysis has been carried out using data analysis, market research, and interviews with key stakeholders. The findings and recommendations presented here aim to give practical advice for improving the company's competitive position.

Findings

Several operational inefficiencies have been found at "GreenTech Solutions". Firstly, workflow bottlenecks have been identified in the production process, leading to delays and higher costs. Secondly, it has been observed that the supply chain management system is outdated, causing inventory mismatches and stockouts (see Appendix). In terms of market expansion, it has been noted that the company's market penetration is limited, with many potential customers not yet reached. Additionally, consumer feedback has indicated a strong demand for innovative and sustainable products, which the current product line does not fully address.

Recommendations

To address the identified issues, several recommendations have been proposed. It is suggested that "GreenTech Solutions" invest in modernizing its production workflow with automation and process optimization to eliminate bottlenecks. Improving the supply chain management system with advanced inventory tracking and forecasting tools is also recommended to enhance efficiency and reduce costs. For market expansion, it is advised that the company implement a targeted marketing strategy focusing on untapped regions and demographics (see Appendix). Additionally, expanding the product line to include more innovative and sustainable solutions is recommended to meet consumer demand and stand out from competitors.

Conclusion

In conclusion, "GreenTech Solutions" has significant opportunities to improve operational efficiency and expand its market presence. By addressing workflow bottlenecks and modernizing the supply chain management system, operational performance can be enhanced, leading to cost savings and better productivity. Targeted marketing and product line expansion are expected to increase market penetration and meet consumer demand for sustainable products. Continuous monitoring and adaptation of these strategies will be crucial for the long-term success and competitiveness of "GreenTech Solutions".

A report by Irish Market Trends - Dun Leoghaire - Dublin-D18 Phone no. 987654321
irishmktrends@cidead.ie

Commissioned by "Green Tech. Solutions"

1

Fernando Braña Asensio. *green tech* ([CC BY-NC-SA](#))

1.-What is the main goal of the report commissioned for "GreenTech Solutions"?

- ☐ To analyze competitor strategies
- ☐ To analyze operational efficiency and market expansion strategies
- ☐ To explore new product development opportunities
- ☐ To study consumer behavior trends

Wrong

Correct Option

Wrong

Wrong

Solution

1. Wrong
2. Correct Option
3. Wrong
4. Wrong

2.- What has been identified as a key operational inefficiency at "GreenTech Solutions"?

- ☐ Marketing strategy flaws
- ☐ Workflow bottlenecks in production
- ☐ Overstaffing issues
- ☐ Lack of innovation in products

Wrong

Correct Option

Wrong

Wrong

Solution

1. Wrong
2. Correct Option
3. Wrong
4. Wrong

3.- How can "GreenTech Solutions" address workflow bottlenecks according to the report?

- ☐ Implement outdated systems
- ☐ Invest in modernizing production workflow
- ☐ Reduce staff numbers
- ☐ Ignore the issue

Wrong

Correct Option

Wrong

Wrong

Solution

1. Wrong
2. Correct Option
3. Wrong
4. Wrong

4.- What is recommended to enhance efficiency and reduce costs in supply chain management?

- ☐ Implement manual tracking methods
- ☐ Invest in advanced inventory tracking tools
- ☐ Increase inventory mismatches
- ☐ Avoid forecasting tools

Wrong

Correct Option

Wrong

Wrong

Solution

1. Wrong
2. Correct Option
3. Wrong
4. Wrong

5.- What is advised to improve market penetration for "GreenTech Solutions"?

- ☐ Focus on the same customer base
- ☐ Implement a generic marketing strategy
- ☐ Expand the product line to include sustainable solutions
- ☐ Disregard demographics

Wrong

Wrong

Correct Option

Wrong

Solution

1. Wrong
2. Wrong
3. Correct Option
4. Wrong

6.- Why is continuous monitoring and adaptation of strategies crucial according to the report?

- ☐ To stay stagnant
- ☐ To ensure failure

- ☐ To maintain competitiveness
- ☐ To avoid growth

Wrong

Wrong

Correct Option

Wrong

Solution

1. Wrong
2. Wrong
3. Correct Option
4. Wrong

7.- Which aspect of the report focuses on consumer demand for innovative products?

- ☐ Conclusion
- ☐ Recommendations
- ☐ Findings
- ☐ Introduction

Wrong

Correct Option

Wrong

Wrong

Solution

1. Wrong
2. Correct Option
3. Wrong
4. Wrong

8.- What is the key area that the current product line of "GreenTech Solutions" does not fully address?

- ☐ Cost efficiency
- ☐ Consumer demand for sustainable products
- ☐ Market saturation
- ☐ Production delays

Wrong

Correct Option

Wrong

Wrong

Solution

1. Wrong
2. Correct Option
3. Wrong
4. Wrong

9.- What type of marketing strategy is recommended for "GreenTech Solutions" according to the report?

- ☐ Broad, unfocused strategy
- ☐ Untargeted strategy
- ☐ Targeted strategy focusing on untapped regions and demographics
- ☐ No marketing strategy

Wrong

Wrong

Correct Option

Wrong

Solution

1. Wrong
2. Wrong
3. Correct Option
4. Wrong

10.- What is the overall purpose of the recommendations provided in the report?

- ☐ To maintain the status quo
- ☐ To hinder growth opportunities
- ☐ To improve operational efficiency and expand market presence
- ☐ To ignore consumer feedback

Wrong

Wrong

Correct Option

Wrong

Solution

1. Wrong
2. Wrong
3. Correct Option
4. Wrong



A Step Ahead

If you want to practise some more reading comprehension and delve into the world of business reports, the following pages offer very useful information

- ✓ [How to Write a Business Report for English Learners](#)
- ✓ [How to write a business report](#)
- ✓ [How to write business reports](#)



Situation

<https://www.youtube.com/embed/V1LGKUkwctM>

Fernando Braña Asensio. *Adam* ([CC BY-NC-SA](#))

Another of my duties at my company is to keep **phone conversations** with different clients. Phone conversations add a personal touch that emails do not usually have so most times a phone call is the best way to get a personal response. Next, you will find a useful guide with set phrases and a couple of conversations where you can see these features in real practice without losing the etiquette that we must have at work. I hope they come in handy for you!

Customer Service phone conversation



Piqsels. phone call (CC BY-NC-SA)

The following activities deal with how to perform one of the tasks that are carried out at the workplace almost on a daily basis. Sometimes, writing an email is not enough and a **phone call** seems to be a more humane, less cold method to clarify things. The following **guide** summarizes some of the **most common phrases** that are used in this kind of context.

Introducing yourself

- ✔ *Hello, this is (name) from (name of company)*
- ✔ *Hi, my name is (name), and I'm calling from (department)*
- ✔ *Hello, this is (name). How can I help you?*
- ✔ *Good morning/afternoon. (name) speaking*
- ✔ *Good afternoon, my name is (name), I'd like to speak to (name)*

If the other person is unavailable

- ✔ *Could you please let/tell (name) know that I called?*
- ✔ *When would be good time to reach (name)?*
- ✔ *Is there someone else who can help me?*
- ✔ *Line is engaged, Can you call back later?*

Dealing with bad connections

- ✔ *I'm sorry, I'm having trouble hearing you. Could you please repeat that?*
- ✔ *It seems the seems the connection is poor. I will hang up and call you right back*
- ✔ *I'm sorry, I think we have a bad connection. Could you please call back?*
- ✔ *I believe you may have the wrong number, but let me try to direct you*
- ✔ *Unfortunately, you've reached the wrong department. I'll transfer you*
- ✔ *I didn't catch your (name/phone number). Could you repeat,*

please?

Ending the call

- ✔ *Thank you for your time. Have a great day!*
- ✔ *Thank you for calling. Have a great day!*
- ✔ *I appreciate your help. Goodbye!*
- ✔ *If you have any further questions, feel free to call me back. Goodbye*
- ✔ *Please feel free to call back if you need further assistance. Goodbye!*

Responding to a caller's request

- ✔ *Who's calling?*
- ✔ *Certainly, let me check that for you*
- ✔ *I'd be happy to help you with that question*
- ✔ *I am not sure, but I will do my best to find it out for you*

Taking a message

- ✔ *Can I take a message for (name)?*
- ✔ *Would you like to leave a message?*
- ✔ *Ok, Mr.(name) I'll put you through*



A customer's phone call

Listen to this conversation between "Chic Boutique" and John Wright, a customer who has phoned to clarify some things. Fill in the blanks with the words you hear

<https://www.youtube.com/embed/Tw2r9DkL5co>

Animated English. A phone call from a customer (Licencia estándar de YouTube)

Chic Boutique: Good morning, Chic Boutique, How [] I help you?

John Wright: I'd like to [] to Mr Morgan, please.

Chic Boutique: Who's [] please?

John Wright: This is John Wright [] International Fashion Supplies.

Chic Boutique: Sorry, I didn't [] your name.

John Wright: John Wright. That's W.R.I.G.H.T.

Chic Boutique: Okay Mr Wright. I'll try and put you [] .I'm afraid the line's [] would you like to [] ? Uh, can I [] a message?

John Wright: Certainly. Could you please [] Mr Morgan our latest shipment has been [] and that the 300 dresses he ordered [] arrive next Friday.

Chic Boutique: Dress order delayed ... arriving next Friday.

John Wright: Yes, and would you please ask him to give me a [] as soon as the [] arrives?

Chic Boutique: Of course. Could you let me have your [] please?

John Wright: Yes, it's zero one six three two nine six zero double nine four.

Chic Boutique: That's oh one six three two nine six oh double nine four (0613290994)

John Wright: Yes, that's [] . Thanks for your help.

Chic Boutique: Goodbye.

John Wright: Goodbye.

Submit



Phone Call

Adam has received a phone call from **Michael**, who works for "**Irish Hurling**", a sports company based in Cork: He wants to know if he can **postpone the payment of his last order**.

Listen to their phone conversation and fill in the gaps



Fernando Braña Asensio (vidnoz). *Adam and Michael phone conversation* ([CC BY-NC-SA](#))

Adam Brannagh: Hello, Adam Brannagh from Irish Market Trends. How can I [] you today?

Michael: Hi Adam, it's Michael here from Irish Hurling. I'm calling [] our recent

Adam Brannagh: Hi Michael! Did everything arrive as expected? We received the confirmation on our end.

Michael: Yes, everything arrived in good condition. However, I wanted to discuss the and the payment terms with you. I need a bit of a favour.

Adam Brannagh: Sure, Michael. What do you need?

Michael: Well, this is a bit awkward, but we're experiencing some issues at the moment. I was if it would be possible to extend the terms from 30 days to 60 days this time.

Adam Brannagh: I understand, Michael. Let me see what I can do. We do have policies to adhere to, and our own cash flow to consider as well.

Michael: I completely understand. I assure you this is just a one-time request. We've got a large coming up that will ease our cash flow significantly.

Adam Brannagh: That's good to hear. you provide a bit more detail about the upcoming project?

Michael: Absolutely. We've secured a with a major client who pays upon . Once we complete the project next month, our cash flow situation will improve dramatically.

Adam Brannagh: That sounds promising. Alright, on for a moment, Michael. Let me check what we can do on our end. Yes, I think we can make an exception and the payment terms to 60 days for this invoice.

Michael: Thank you so much, Adam. I really appreciate it.

Adam Brannagh: No problem at all, Michael. We value our partnership with "Irish Hurling". Just make sure to stay in and keep us on your situation.

Michael: Will do. Also, I'd like to place a new similar to the last one. I'll send the details in an email shortly.

Adam Brannagh: Great! I'll keep an out for your email. We'll process the new order as soon as we receive it.

Michael: Thank you again, Adam. Could you send me a confirmation email about the payment terms extension?

Adam Brannagh: Of course. I'll get that to you right away.

Michael: Perfect. for your help, Adam. Talk to you soon.

Adam Brannagh: You're Michael. Goodbye.

Submit



A Step Ahead

The following links to **lingua.com website**, will come in handy if you are looking for some further practice

- ✓ [Business phone calls](#) 
- ✓ [Leaving a message](#) 
- ✓ [Returning a phone call](#) 
- ✓ [Customer service: problem solving](#) 



Situation

<https://www.youtube.com/embed/uGr6803mPTs>

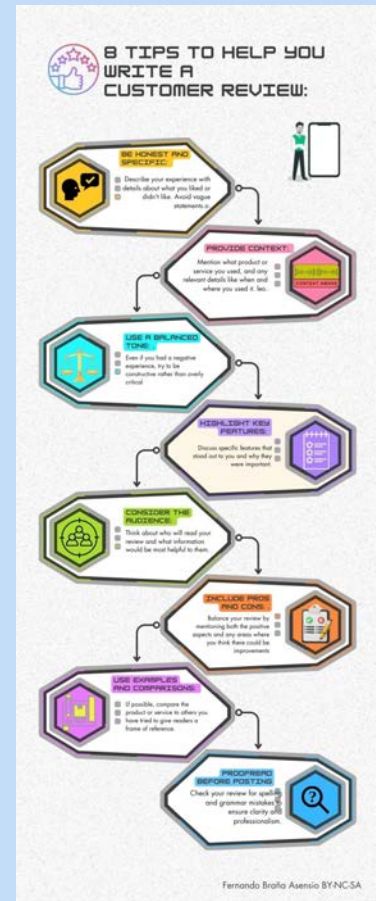
Fernando Braña Asensio. *Adam* ([CC BY-NC-SA](#))

Apart from answering the phone to talk to clients or writing reports, I have to **write customer reviews**. My company is also a client of other companies so this is an important aspect of my job. It helps us to make informed decisions, provides feedback to businesses and helps them improve or be visible online

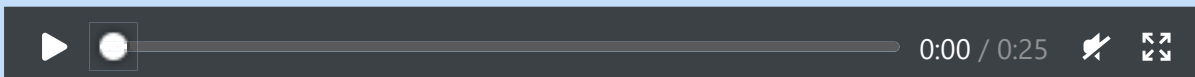
This is the last section of the course, so thanks for joining me in this professional english course. **I wish you the best of luck!**

A customer review

Writing a customer review is important for various reasons. It helps other consumers because reviews provide **valuable insights** for potential buyers, helping them to make informed decisions. It provides feedback to businesses and help them understand their **strengths and areas for improvement**. Positive reviews can build a **business's reputation**, which builds credibility and trust. It also enhances **product quality** which can lead to better services. Reviews can also impact **search engine rankings** and the **visibility** of businesses **online**. They also foster a **sense of community** among consumers, encouraging shared experiences, which can be personally fulfilling and help others in the process.



Fernando Braña Asensio. 8 tips customer review ([CC BY-NC-SA](#))



Fernando Braña Asensio. 32 words customer review

Match the contexts and the customer reviews

In these cards you will find different contexts in which we can write a review of a product or service. Have a look at how they are written and match them appropriately.

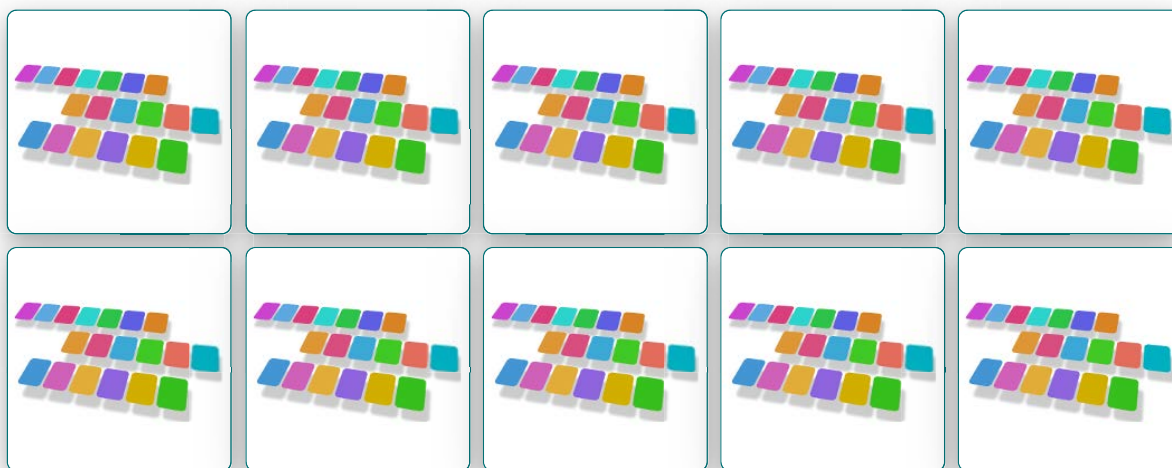
10 ✓ 0

Choose a level

15:00



Easy Intermediate Difficult



AUTHOR; Fernando Braña Asensio



Scrambled customer review



https://www.pigsels.com/en_customers_review
(CC BY-NC-SA)

The following is a customers review form "**Irish Markets Trends**", the company Adam works for. They have recently bought laptops for all the company's employees to "**Laptop One**", an IT company in Dublin. **Adam was in charge of writing the review** but mixed

everything up when he saved the document in his computer. **Can you help him sort this out, please?**

Compared to our previous laptops, the Laptop One Pro offers significantly better performance and battery life. ▼

Tasks that used to take several minutes are now completed in seconds, greatly enhancing our workflow. ▲ ▼

The built-in speakers could be better for high-quality audio during video conferences, and we encountered a few software glitches during the initial setup, which delayed the process slightly. ▲ ▼

Additionally, the average battery life of around 10 hours allows our employees to work throughout the day without needing to recharge, which is a major plus for our field agents and remote workers. ▲ ▼

The slim and lightweight design also makes them easy to carry, although they are slightly heavier than some ultrabooks. ▲ ▼

Overall, we are very satisfied with our purchase from Laptop One. These laptops have boosted our productivity and provided the reliability we need. ▲ ▼

These laptops were chosen for their performance and reliability, ensuring our team could work efficiently both in the office and remotely. ▲ ▼

Despite minor areas for improvement, the overall value and performance are excellent. ▲ ▼

The laptops feature the latest Intel i7 processors and 16GB of RAM, which handle demanding tasks with ease, improving our productivity significantly. The 15.6-inch Full HD displays are bright and clear, perfect for design work and presentations. ▲ ▼

While we are generally satisfied, there are a few areas for improvement. ▲ ▼

Our company, Irish Market Trends, recently purchased a batch of Laptop One Pro laptops for all our employees, and our experience has been largely positive. ▲ ▼

We highly recommend the Laptop One Pro for any business in need of robust and efficient laptops. ▲

Check



Customer Review

A workmate from "Irsh Market Trends" has just sent me this audio with a review of a cleaning company "Sparkle Clean", Can you help me fill the missing blanks?



Fernando Braña Asensio (clipchamp). *Sparkle Clean review* ([CC BY-NC-SA](#))

I recently decided to try out "SparkleClean" for a deep cleaning of my home, and I must say, I am thoroughly [REDACTED] with their service. From start to finish, they demonstrated [REDACTED] and attention to detail that exceeded my [REDACTED].

Booking the service was a breeze. Their website was user-friendly, allowing me to select the cleaning package that suited my needs best. Their customer service team was prompt and [REDACTED], answering all my questions.

On the day of the cleaning, the "SparkleClean" team arrived right on schedule, equipped with all the necessary cleaning supplies and equipment. They were [REDACTED] and [REDACTED], taking care to explain their process and ensuring they understood my specific requests.

The deep cleaning itself was truly [REDACTED]. The team meticulously cleaned every corner of my home, from top to bottom. They didn't just surface clean; they went above and beyond, moving furniture to clean underneath, dusting blinds and baseboards, and meticulously scrubbing kitchen and bathroom surfaces.

I was particularly impressed with their use of [REDACTED] cleaning products. Not only did my home look clean, but it also smelled fresh and sanitized. The [REDACTED] to detail was evident throughout the entire process, and they even cleaned areas I hadn't thought of, like the tops of ceiling fans and light fixtures.

After the cleaning was complete, I did a walkthrough with the team leader to ensure everything met my expectations. I was [REDACTED] to see that they had addressed all my concerns and left no corner untouched.

While the service was [REDACTED], there were a few minor considerations. The cost of the deep cleaning service was on the higher side compared to other cleaning services I've used in the past. However, the thoroughness and [REDACTED] of the work justified the price. Additionally, the cleaning took a bit longer than initially estimated, but again, this was because they were so thorough in their work.

Overall, I am highly [REDACTED] with SparkleClean and would not hesitate to recommend them to anyone looking for a reliable and thorough home cleaning service. They surpassed my expectations with their professionalism, attention to [REDACTED], and commitment to customer [REDACTED]. I will definitely be using their services again in the future.

Submit



A Step Ahead

Click on the following links for further practice on writing customer reviews

- ✓ [Writing a review](#) 
- ✓ [Writing reviews worksheets](#) 
- ✓ [How to write a review](#) 
- ✓ [Write and Improve](#) 

